

Regency, Empire and Federal styles

Despite the advent of new movements in the 19th century, such as Arts and Crafts and Orientalism, neoclassicism endured as a popular architectural style. In Britain, where it was characterized by elegance and simplicity, it became known as the Regency style after George, Prince Regent from 1811–20, who commissioned John Nash to lay out some of the best-known areas of central London. Regency coincides with the Biedermeier style (1815–48) in German-speaking lands. In France, neoclassicism became known as Empire style, taking its name from Napoleon I's Empire of 1800 to 1815, and following his orders to uphold the standards of Republican Rome. (A neoclassical aesthetic had also pervaded France's Directoire style of the 1790s.) Charles Percier (1764–1838) and Pierre Fontaine (1762–1853) were prominent architects of the Empire style. The Empire and Georgian styles strongly influenced the Federal style that emerged in the United States between c.1780 and 1830, often called 'Adam style' after the Scottish brothers Robert (1728–92) and James (1732–94) Adam.



Brunswick Terrace, Brighton, built in the Regency Style around 1825.